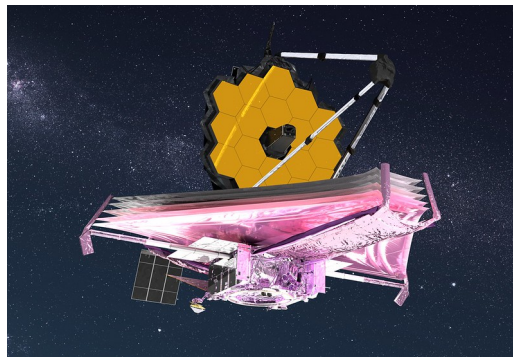


# Editor's Note

Josephine Lee



Artist conception of the James Webb Space Telescope

*“Webb was worth the wait!”*

- John Mather, Webb senior project scientist and Nobel Laureate astrophysicist,  
NASA Goddard

Did you watch it launch? Did you read about its incredible capabilities? Are you excited to marvel at all the images it will capture?

On the morning of Christmas Day, December 25, 2021, NASA launched the James Webb Space Telescope, more than 30 years after it was first envisioned. According to NASA's website, this 6.5-meter infrared space telescope is the world's largest and most complex, powerful enough to “study every phase of the history of our Universe.” Whoa.

Even though I'm not literally or figuratively a rocket scientist and have no background in aeronautics/astronautics, I am in awe of the scope and the scale of this feat of engineering collaboration decades in the making. It took roughly \$10 billion and the perseverance of 20,000 engineers, technicians, computer programmers, and scientists from NASA, the European Space Agency (ESA), and the Canadian Space Agency (CSA) to make this prolonged and arduous journey, but now the dream has become a reality which will expand the boundaries of scientific knowledge for decades to come.

As I look back over my four years at Stuy and my role as Editor-in-Chief of three editions of *Math Survey*, I'm just beginning to realize the value of peering into the past to see farther into the future. I didn't appreciate it at the time, but all the long hours of studying and all the hard work of publishing forced me to tap into an inner reserve of determination that I didn't even know I had. Thanks to the dedication of family, friends, alumni, faculty, and administration, I can now look back at my high school career with a little of that same sense of awe (plus a certain amount

of relief) and look forward to college and beyond with anticipation and curiosity.

On behalf of the *Math Survey* staff, I would like to thank Principal Seung Yu and Math and Computer Science Department Assistant Principal Eric Smith for their faithful leadership through a global pandemic that seemed like it would never end. I am also deeply grateful to our faculty advisor, Mr. Gary Rubinstein, whose vision of the future of *Math Survey* was always informed and inspired by its memorable past. To the Stuyvesant math and computer science faculty, both old and new, we students will never forget how tirelessly and sacrificially you invested in our lives and education; thank you, thank you, thank you. And to the resilient staff of *Math Survey*, we did it again, one article, interview, puzzle, and graphic at a time!

To my fellow members of the Class of 2022, graduating from Stuy was worth the wait. Congratulations!